Name:Nidhi Patil
Cybersecurity Intern
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Task 25

INCIDENT RESPONSE

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1. Introduction

Incident response is the process of identifying, managing, and recovering from cybersecurity incidents such as malware infections, phishing attacks, and unauthorized access.

The main goal is to reduce damage, protect data, and restore normal operations as quickly and safely as possible.

2. Incident Response Checklist

Stage 1: Preparation

- ☐ Create an incident response plan.
- ☐ Identify important systems and data.
- ☐ Keep backups of important files.
- ☐ Install and update antivirus software.
- ☐ Define the roles and responsibilities of the response team.

Stage 2: Detection and Analysis

- ☐ Identify suspicious activities or security alerts.
- ☐ Check system logs and security notifications.
- ☐ Determine the type and severity of the incident.

- ☐ Identify affected devices, accounts, and systems.
- ☐ Record the incident details, date, and time.

Stage 3: Containment

- ☐ Isolate affected devices from the network when necessary.
- ☐ Disable compromised accounts if required.
- ☐ Block malicious IP addresses or domains where appropriate.
- ☐ Prevent the incident from spreading to other systems.
- ☐ Preserve relevant logs and evidence.

Stage 4: Eradication

- ☐ Identify and remove malware or malicious files.
- ☐ Fix the vulnerability that caused the incident.
- ☐ Reset compromised passwords and revoke suspicious sessions.
- ☐ Apply necessary security patches.
- ☐ Verify that the threat has been removed.

Stage 5: Recovery

- ☐ Restore affected systems from clean backups when needed.
- ☐ Test systems before returning them to normal operation.
- ☐ Monitor systems for suspicious activities.
- ☐ Confirm that services and applications are working correctly.
- ☐ Inform relevant stakeholders about the recovery status.

Stage 6: Lessons Learned

- ☐ Document the incident, response actions, and impact.
- ☐ Identify the root cause of the incident.
- ☐ Evaluate what worked and what needs improvement.
- ☐ Update security policies and response procedures.
- ☐ Provide security awareness training if required.

3. Example of an Incident

Scenario: An employee opens a malicious email attachment, and the computer shows signs of malware infection.

Response:

1. Detect the infection through antivirus alerts or suspicious activity.
2. Isolate the affected computer to prevent the malware from spreading.
3. Investigate the incident and preserve relevant evidence.
4. Remove the malware and fix the security weakness.
5. Restore the computer safely and monitor it.
6. Document the incident and educate employees about phishing emails.

Interview Questions

Q1. What is incident response?

Incident response is the process of detecting, investigating, containing, and recovering from cybersecurity incidents.

Q2. What is containment?

Containment means limiting the spread and impact of a security incident. For example, disconnecting an infected computer from the network.

Q3. What happens after recovery?

After recovery, the team monitors the systems, documents the incident, identifies lessons learned, and improves security measures.

5. Conclusion

Incident response helps organizations manage cybersecurity incidents effectively. Following preparation, detection, containment, eradication,

recovery, and lessons learned helps reduce damage and improve future security.